



Printing goof ups, missing RAM, Web page errors— get the fixes for your PC's ailments

Applications

Hardware and software decoders

Q I have a problem with my DVD player. I have a P-III 700 MHz CPU and Windows Me as the OS. When I try to run a DVD disk in Win DVD, which I obtained from C:\windows\dvdplay.exe, I get the following error message: 'To use the DVD player, you need to install either a software DVD decoder or a hardware DVD decoder. For more information click Help.' What are hardware and software decoders and how can I get these?

Ameya Sathye

Via e-mail

A In order to play a DVD disk, the DVD files on it need to be decoded and displayed on your monitor. There are two ways of doing this, either by using a special card (a DVD decoder card) or a software that can read and play DVD disks using the system's main processor. These are known as DVD decoders.

Hardware DVD decoders usually cost significantly more but for your needs, your Pentium III 700 MHz processor with a software

DVD decoder will be more than capable.

Writer won't write

Q I tried Nero Burning Rom v5.4.4.8 Demo (October 2001, Mindware) with my new CD-Writer (HP CD-12 series) but I'm experiencing some problems while writing/simulation. After compilation, when I try to write/simulate, it detects both my CD-Writer and the blank CD-R media disk but shows an error, 'Invalid field in parameter. Aborting the job'.

Sourav Basu

Via e-mail

A Make sure you have the right ASPI drivers installed. Also, according to the log file you sent us, the DMA (Direct Memory Access) for your writer is off. Turn it on and also turn Auto Insert Notification off and Disconnect on. You can get the latest ASPI drivers from Adaptec's Web site if you use any Adaptec software such as Easy CD creator, that are bundled along with your CD Writer. This should solve your problem.

Tally error

Q I have a brand new PC with the following configuration: Pentium 4, 1.5 GHz, 256 MB

RAM, 40 GB hard disk and Windows 98 SE running on it. Tally 4.5 used to run smoothly on my old PC (Pentium 100 MHz, 16 MB RAM, 1.9 GB hard disk and Windows 98 SE OS), but in this new configuration it gives me the following error: 'Tally abnormal completion. Status:3. Insufficient files provided by DOS. Internal error. Contact Peutronics.'

The main thing is it works fine in DOS mode without any lines being added in config.sys, but in Windows it shows errors!

Ravi Meghani

Via e-mail

A You need to run Tally from the command prompt mode in Windows. Start a standard

file is being run individually by Windows in a separate shell, like a temp folder. If you create a shortcut that sets the 'run in' folder of the program to **C:\tally**, that should solve the problem.

Word doesn't check grammar

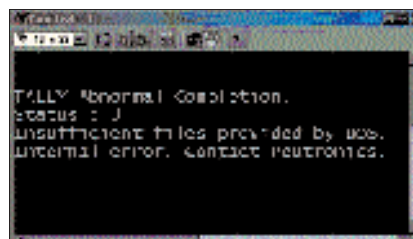
Q When I try to run a grammar check in Microsoft Word 2000, I get the following error message: 'There was an unexpected error in the grammar checker. Word cannot complete the grammar check.' I've tried to solve this by uninstalling and installing Word repeatedly, but all in vain.

Nibhay Joshi

Via e-mail

A It seems the program Office2000 has not been installed properly. First uninstall Microsoft Office by going to Add/Remove programs. Then go to Program files and delete the Microsoft Office folder. Lastly, go to the registry and delete the Microsoft Office registry entries.

Before deleting any registry entries make sure you take a backup. Now reinstall



Error while starting Tally

command prompt, change to the Tally folder by typing **cd C:\tally**, and then run **t.exe** from the command prompt itself. The problem you've encountered is because the